Transcript in English

Watch this hacker break into a company

[Visual information: A documentary shows Laurie Segall and David Kennedy sitting inside a room with two other people. David Kennedy is talking on the phone with Ken, who is offscreen. The other three people are listening attentively.]

«Hacker?»

Laurie Segall (voiceover):
What do you think of when I say the word “hacker”? Some creepy dude in a basement? Well, that’s a misconception. What if I told you there’s a class of hackers who don’t just have social skills? They have more social intelligence than anyone you’ll ever meet. David Kennedy is one of them. He’s what’s known as a social engineer, or a people hacker. His craft is to dupe you into doing things and sharing information you probably shouldn’t.

David Kennedy:
Can I just get your credit card number?

Laurie Segall (voiceover):
Some use it for illegal activity. In David’s case, companies pay him to find out if employees are leaving the company vulnerable. He and his team show us how it’s done. Step one: spoof his number so it looks like he’s calling from inside the company, and then call tech support.

David Kennedy:
Hello, you there? Hello?

Ken:
Hi, this is Ken. How may I help you?

«David Kennedy, hacker»

David Kennedy:
I was wondering if you can take a look at a website I’m trying to get to. It’s for a big customer thing I’m working on for Monday, and I can’t seem to get to the website from my computer.

Ken:
Sure, what’s the website? I’ll see if I can get to it.

David Kennedy:
Thanks, man, I really appreciate the help. I mean, it could be a stupid thing. I really suck with computers, but... So it’s www.survey-pro.com.

Ken:
Yeah, I got a prompt to open, I just clicked open and I'm at the site now.

Laurie Segall (voiceover):
Here's what the IT guy doesn't realise. By clicking that link, he's just given David full access to his computer.

David Kennedy:
Whoa, okay, that's weird. I just hit it and it seems like it's working fine now. Awesome. I don't know what you did, man, but I really appreciate the help.

Ken:
Hey, no problem. That was easy.

Laurie Segall:
That was it?

David Kennedy:
We're on his computer right now.

«Laurie Segall, CNN Money, Senior Technology Correspondent»

Laurie Segall:
You were able to take over this guy's computer within, I would say, like, under two minutes.

David Kennedy:
Under two minutes, yeah. Under two minutes I took over his entire computer, and think of it as not just his computer, but it's pretty much the downfall of the entire company.

Laurie Segall (voiceover):
In this case, the company was paying David to hack them and see if their employees would fall for it. They did. To show you this demo, we agreed not to use the company's name. Kennedy hacks to protect. He's part of a growing number of hackers using this skill for good. Josh Corman's one of them too. He started a group to help bridge the gap between hackers and big companies.

[Visual information: Laurie Segall and Josh Corman are in Josh Corman's sitting room, decorated with Spider-Man-themed items. Some close-up shots of Spider-Man comic scenes are shown.]

«Josh Corman»

Josh Corman:
Hacking is a form of power. Not surprisingly, as you walked into my house and saw all the Spider-Man stuff, I'm a big fan of the Stan Lee line of, "With great power comes great responsibility." We're coming to a point where the outside world, with a breach a week, a breach a day, affecting people's personal lives and national security, we got to grow up a bit, and we need to be very deliberate about how we use that power.

Laurie Segall (voiceover):
Corman formed the group after his mum passed away.

Josh Corman:
She was my science teacher. She kind of taught me that darkness is the absence of light, cold is the absence of heat. You know, if you see something missing in the world, maybe it's our job to put it there. I think the world's going to be whatever we want it to be and whatever we make it. There are very, very bad people, which means it falls to the good people to try to fight it.

Laurie Segall:
You feel like you have a very personal responsibility.

Josh Corman:
We have so much potential to shape our culture, our values, our safety. If not us, then who?